



OpenAI

ChatGPT 'Dreaming': what actually changed in OpenAI's memory architecture

swipe →



1

The old system

You'd ask ChatGPT to remember something. It saved a text note. Simple, manual, and easy to audit.



2

What 'Dreaming' actually does

A background process now synthesizes memory from years of conversations automatically. Factual recall: 41.5% in 2024, 82.8% in 2026 on OpenAI's internal eval.



3

The privacy catch nobody read

Deleting a conversation doesn't remove what ChatGPT learned from it. You must delete both the memory entry and the originating conversation. Deleted logs kept up to 30 days.



4

The architecture question for builders

Memory now lives outside the conversation context. Agent systems have been doing this for years. The difference is who controls what gets retained and what gets erased.



5

The 7-week deadline

EU AI Act memory transparency requirements take effect August 2, 2026. OpenAI has roughly 7 weeks to reconcile 'smarter' with 'actually deletable.'



The question worth sitting with

If you can't verify what a system remembers about you, can you trust it?

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